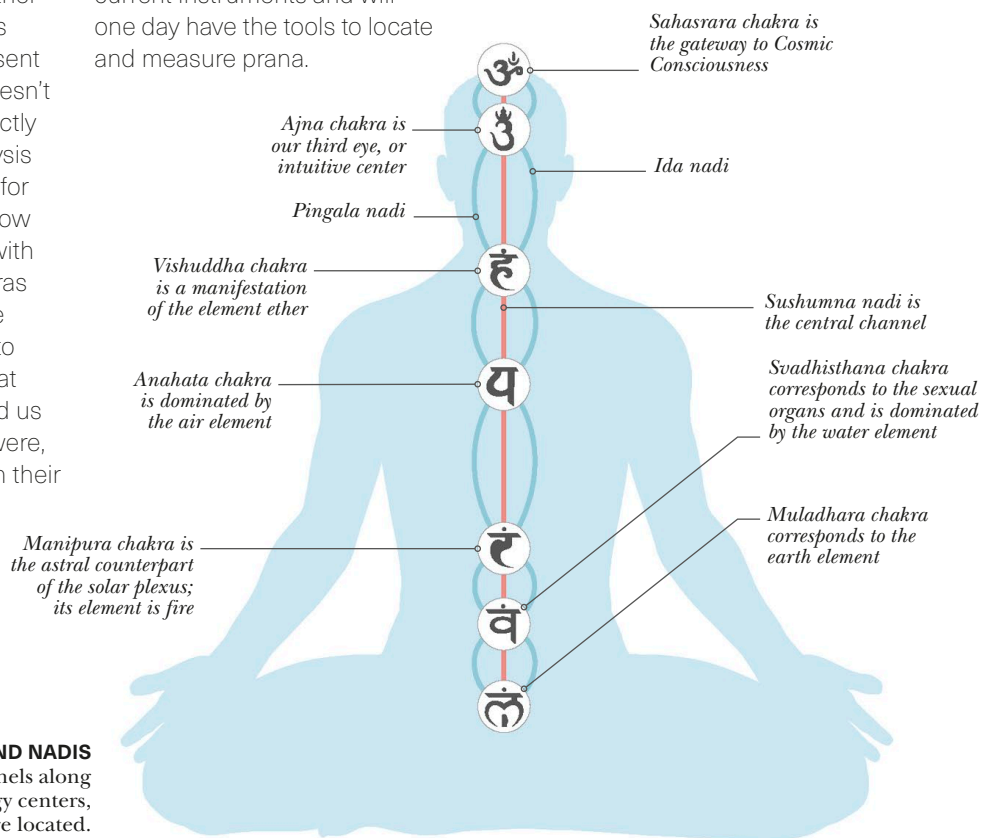


Q IS THERE SCIENTIFIC EVIDENCE TO SUPPORT YOGIC CONCEPTS, SUCH AS PRANA AND THE CHAKRAS?

Yoga research tends to focus on specific health conditions and practical benefits, rather than subtle energetics, as prana and chakras represent a way of knowing that doesn't necessarily translate directly to a straightforward analysis of biology. Some people, for example, claim that the flow of prana is in alignment with the nerves, and the chakras with the glands, but there is no scientific evidence to support this. It may be that before dissection showed us where these structures were, yogis felt them working in their

bodies. It is also possible that we are still limited by our current instruments and will one day have the tools to locate and measure prana.



Q HOW MUCH RESEARCH IS THERE INTO YOGA?

Research into yoga is relatively limited, albeit on the rise, and fast. A bibliometric review of the relevant research from 1967 to 2013, for example, showed an exponential growth in the number of studies conducted from fewer than 25 publications from 1967–1973 to well over 225 publications in 2009–2013,

correlating with the rise of popularity of yoga.

The research also identifies that the top four areas of research are:

- mental health disorders
- cardiovascular disease
- respiratory diseases
- musculoskeletal disorders.